



War begins

Boeing begins the war by shooting down a UAV bot

Robot rights

California Polytechnic wants bots to have similar rights as men

It happened while I was downstairs, taking out the garbage (why don't they have robots for that yet?). Some crazy motorist lost control of his car and rammed right into a class-3 service ckBot. It's weird, seeing a robot disintegrate like that. I mean, I knew it was a ckBot, but still...

But, of course, there's the thrill of watching all the parts crawl towards each other and re-assemble themselves into the robot again. It's like hitting a rewind button.

So. As promised, I must tell you some of the history of this incredible bot: Like so many robots, ckBot debuted at a science fair - Wired's NextFest 2008, to be precise. It started out as a bipedal (and I use this term loosely) robot, made up of several parts that were magnetically attached to each other. Each part had wheels that enabled them to move around when disassembled, so if broken apart, they could move towards each other till the magnets took over and ckBot was whole again.

In the years since then, creator [Mark Yim](#) has perfected the ckBot, and even made different models for different purposes. The Class-3 bots you see cleaning the streets are the most basic models - no frills, and can't take much more than a car crash. The coolest ones are the Class-1 bots - used only by the military on special (read über-dangerous) missions. They can survive mini-nuclear attacks at close range, and if the individual parts are too far from each other to communicate, they can each act as a weapon.

Obviously, it's not likely I'll see the Class-1s do their thing. I'm pretty sure I don't want to be in the vicinity when something attacks them.

Posted by RobotFan at 10.22 AM 8 Comments

APRIL 22, 2047

NEWS: RoboKind Goes Under

From [RoboBiz.com](#):

"In an announcement this morning, a spokesperson for [RoboKind](#) (formerly Hanson Robotics) declared that the company will be closing its doors early next month. This news doesn't come as a shock - just last month, the company announced that it was ending the Zeno project for lack of support from robot developers..."

I'm not surprised either. I've been skeptical about this [Zeno nonsense](#) from the day it was announced back in 2008. I got this tidbit from the [WayBack Machine](#):

"Zeno is coming! He is the smartest and coolest robot yet! He has everything he needs to become your friend; he sees, hears, talks and remembers who you are."

What use could something like this be? [David Hanson](#) (the creator) kept talking about Zeno paving the way for "robot ethics", but I could never figure it out. Zeno was just another toy with a fancy tagline, I think.

Also, look at him - he's a horror movie waiting to happen:

Posted by RobotFan at 10.22 AM 14 Comments

APRIL 12, 2047

Hello, World!

...and welcome to my new robot blog! As you know, scientists [estimate](#) that it's roughly one year to Singularity Day (or S-Day, as I shall call it from now on) - the day when the technology we create develops the ability to improve itself.

This means that we won't have to waste our time thinking about new products, or developing new technologies - we'll have our robot friends to do that! Which means more vacations for me! So, in honour of our soon-to-be-independent friends, I've created this blog. Over the year, I'll be talking about the stories behind all the robots that are now part of our lives. Enjoy!

Posted by RobotFan at 12.07 PM 2 Comments ■

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About Me

Well, I'm a fan of robots, LOL! I've not studied them or anything, I just like what they mean for society (vacations!!).

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Sites I Visit

[RoboTimes.com](#)

[RoboBiz.com](#)

[iRobot.com](#)

